from a single person now into multiple persons at a future time. No choices come into the matter anywhere.

On the other hand, we can also contemplate a weaker notion of free will, one that refers to the macroscopically available knowledge we actually have about the world, rather than running thought experiments based on microscopically perfect knowledge. In that case, a different form of unpredictability arises. Given a person and what we (or they, or anyone) know about their current mental state, there will typically be many different specific arrangements of atoms and molecules in their bodies and brains that are compatible with that knowledge. Some of those arrangements may lead to sufficiently different neural processes that we would end up acting very differently, if those arrangements had been true. In that case, the best we can realistically do to describe the way human beings (or other conscious agents) act in the real world is to attribute volition to them—the ability to choose differently.

Attributing volition to people is what every one of us actually does as we go through life talking about ourselves and others. For practical purposes it doesn't matter whether we could predict the future from perfect knowledge of the present, because we don't have such knowledge, nor will we ever. This has led philosophers, going back as far as Thomas Hobbes, to propose *compatibilism* between underlying deterministic laws and the reality of human choice-making. Most modern philosophers are compatibilists about free will (which doesn't mean it's right, of course). Free will is real, just like tables and temperature and branches of the wave function.

As far as quantum mechanics is concerned, it doesn't matter whether you are a compatibilist or an incompatibilist concerning free will. In neither case should quantum uncertainty affect your stance; even if you can't predict the outcome of a quantum measurement, that outcome stems from the laws of physics, not any personal choices made by you. We don't create the world by our actions, our actions are part of the world.

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I would be remiss to talk about the human side of Many-Worlds without confronting the question of consciousness. There is a long history of